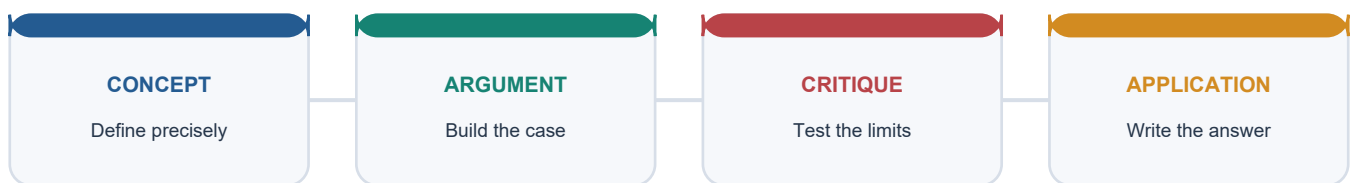


SOLVED PRACTICE WORKBOOK

National Integration and Foreign Policy - Solved Practice Workbook

UPSC complete learning session | Foundation to advanced | Concepts, evidence, practice and answer writing

LEARNING PATH



Deterministic fallback visual: move from precise concepts through argument and critique to exam application.

Source order: repository knowledge -> official current linkage -> clearly marked analysis. No fabricated PYQs or statistics.

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Major learning parts and meaningful subtopics are listed in document order. Page numbers are generated from the final PDF layout; PDF bookmarks mirror the same hierarchy.

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Polity 45 - National Integration and Foreign Policy - Solved Practice Workbook

Subject: Polity | **GS Paper:** GS-II with routed GS-I/IR applications | **Legal/current control date:** 8 September 2026

Practice discipline: exactly 32 original MCQs before the PYQ section; answer order ABCD repeated eight times; 128 substantive option-specific explanations; 32 question-specific traps; verified relevant descriptive PYQs with official-key discipline; exactly six original Mains models.

Exactly **32 original MCQs** appear before the PYQ section. Questions 25-32 provide treaty, institution and doctrine remediation. Correct-answer sequence: ABCDABCDABCDABCDABCDABCDABCDABCD.

BASIC MCQS / REMEDIATION

MCQ 1. Conceptual definition

Which formulation best defines national integration?

A. Equal constitutional membership across legitimate diversity B. Permanent cultural sameness C. Territorial control without citizenship equality D. The absence of all regional organisations

Answer: A. Equal constitutional membership across legitimate diversity

Option-specific explanations:

- **A:** Correct: it combines common membership with protected difference.
- **B:** Cultural sameness mistakes integration for compulsory assimilation.
- **C:** Control is necessary but cannot alone create civic belonging.
- **D:** Regional organisation may channel claims peacefully rather than negate unity.

Examiner trap 1: Test whether the option preserves both common citizenship and legitimate diversity.

MCQ 2. Assimilation and accommodation

Which statement correctly distinguishes assimilation from accommodation?

A. Accommodation requires one dominant culture. B. Assimilation absorbs difference; accommodation protects difference within common rules. C. Assimilation creates a constitutional right to secede. D. Accommodation exempts groups from equality norms.

Answer: B. Assimilation absorbs difference; accommodation protects difference within common rules.

Option-specific explanations:

- **A:** This reverses accommodation's plural logic.
- **B:** Correct: the distinction concerns whether difference remains institutionally recognised.
- **C:** Neither model creates a secession right.
- **D:** Accommodation remains bounded by equality, accountability and common law.

Examiner trap 2: Reject options that convert accommodation into separate sovereignty or legal immunity.

MCQ 3. Preamble linkage

The Preamble links fraternity most directly with:

A. Only adult suffrage B. Only territorial administration C. Dignity of the individual and unity and integrity of the nation D. A judicially enforceable Fundamental Duty

Answer: C. Dignity of the individual and unity and integrity of the nation

Option-specific explanations:

- **A:** Adult suffrage is vital but not the Preamble's fraternity phrase.
- **B:** Territorial administration omits dignity and civic solidarity.
- **C:** Correct: the text expressly joins these ideas.

- **D:** Fraternity is a Preamble value, not itself a separately enforceable duty.

Examiner trap 3: Recall the exact dignity-unity-integrity sequence.

MCQ 4. Union of States

Which proposition about Article 1 is safest?

A. It gives every State a right to withdraw. B. It declares India a federation formed by a revocable compact. C. It prevents Parliament from changing internal boundaries. D. India is a Union of States, while territorial change follows constitutional procedure.

Answer: D. India is a Union of States, while territorial change follows constitutional procedure.

Option-specific explanations:

- **A:** No unilateral secession right follows from Article 1.
- **B:** The Constitution does not rest on a revocable State compact.
- **C:** Articles 2-4 allow constitutionally controlled territorial change.
- **D:** Correct: durability of Union coexists with internal adaptability.

Examiner trap 4: Do not import compact theory into the phrase 'Union of States'.

MCQ 5. Article 3 procedure

Which statement about an Article 3 Bill is correct?

A. It requires the President's recommendation and referral for the affected State legislature's views. B. It requires consent of every State legislature. C. It is always an Article 368 amendment. D. It may cede Indian territory to a foreign State by ordinary law.

Answer: A. It requires the President's recommendation and referral for the affected State legislature's views.

Option-specific explanations:

- **A:** Correct: recommendation and consultation are mandatory procedural elements.
- **B:** The affected State legislature has a voice, not a constitutional veto.
- **C:** Article 4 excludes specified consequential changes from Article 368 treatment.
- **D:** Foreign cession raises a distinct constitutional issue.

Examiner trap 5: Separate consultation from consent and internal reorganisation from external cession.

MCQ 6. Article 19 mobility

Which is constitutionally accurate?

A. Residence preference is always forbidden. B. Article 19 protects citizen movement and residence, subject to Article 19(5) restrictions. C. State domicile replaces Indian citizenship for admissions. D. Sons-of-soil exclusion is automatically valid when popular.

Answer: B. Article 19 protects citizen movement and residence, subject to Article 19(5) restrictions.

Option-specific explanations:

- **A:** Bounded preferences may be justified in limited contexts.
- **B:** Correct: rights and the specific restriction clause must be read together.
- **C:** Pradeep Jain rejected separate State domicile as the governing identity.
- **D:** Popularity does not cure unequal or disproportionate exclusion.

Examiner trap 6: Use the correct Article 19(5) limit rather than an absolute rule.

MCQ 7. Cultural rights

Article 29(1) protects:

A. Only institutions recognised by the National Commission for Minorities B. Only religious practices C. Any section of citizens with a distinct language, script or culture seeking conservation D. Only languages in the Eighth Schedule

Answer: C. Any section of citizens with a distinct language, script or culture seeking conservation

Option-specific explanations:

- **A:** Commission recognition is not the textual trigger.
- **B:** Religious practice is chiefly addressed by Articles 25-28.
- **C:** Correct: the clause is framed for any qualifying section of citizens.
- **D:** Eighth Schedule listing is not required by Article 29(1).

Examiner trap 7: Do not narrow Article 29(1) to notified minorities.

MCQ 8. Linguistic safeguards

Which pair is correctly matched?

A. Article 350A - national language declaration B. Article 350B - State power to expel migrants C. Article 351 - Special Officer for linguistic minorities D. Article 350A - primary-stage mother-tongue facilities; Article 350B - Special Officer

Answer: D. Article 350A - primary-stage mother-tongue facilities; Article 350B - Special Officer

Option-specific explanations:

- **A:** Article 350A concerns educational facilities, not a national language.
- **B:** Article 350B creates an officer, not expulsion power.
- **C:** The Special Officer is under Article 350B, not Article 351.
- **D:** Correct: both provision-function matches are precise.

Examiner trap 8: Keep 350A, 350B and 351 institutionally distinct.

MCQ 9. Fundamental Duties

Which set was inserted with Part IVA by the 42nd Amendment Act, 1976?

A. Article 51A(c), (e), (f) and (i) B. Only Article 51A(k) C. Article 44 and Article 51 D. Articles 14-19

Answer: A. Article 51A(c), (e), (f) and (i)

Option-specific explanations:

- **A:** Correct: these duties concern integrity, harmony, composite culture, public property and violence.
- **B:** Clause (k) was added later through the 86th Amendment.
- **C:** Articles 44 and 51 are DPSPs, not Fundamental Duties.
- **D:** Articles 14-19 are Fundamental Rights and pre-date Part IVA.

Examiner trap 9: Distinguish the 42nd-Amendment duties from later clause (k).

MCQ 10. DPSP boundary

Which statement is most accurate?

A. Article 44 directly invalidates all personal law. B. Article 38 addresses welfare and inequalities; Article 44 states a non-justiciable endeavour toward a uniform civil code. C. Article 38 guarantees identical State incomes. D. Article 44 is the sole constitutional basis of integration.

Answer: B. Article 38 addresses welfare and inequalities; Article 44 states a non-justiciable endeavour toward a uniform civil code.

Option-specific explanations:

- **A:** Article 44 is not self-executing invalidation.

- **B:** Correct: both clauses are bounded DPSP directions.
- **C:** Article 38 directs State policy but does not guarantee identical outcomes.
- **D:** Integration also rests on rights, federalism, fraternity and institutions.

Examiner trap 10: Use Article 44 cautiously and do not equate legal uniformity with national unity.

MCQ 11. Pradeep Jain

What is the safest reading of *Pradeep Jain v Union of India* (1984)?

A. All residence preference is unconstitutional. B. States possess separate constitutional citizenship. C. India-wide domicile is the baseline, while limited residence preference may be justified for local needs. D. Migrants may be collectively excluded from public education.

Answer: C. India-wide domicile is the baseline, while limited residence preference may be justified for local needs.

Option-specific explanations:

- **A:** The judgment did not impose an absolute ban on every preference.
- **B:** The Constitution provides one citizenship rather than State citizenship.
- **C:** Correct: it balances national mobility with bounded local considerations.
- **D:** Collective exclusion is inconsistent with the judgment's integrative reasoning.

Examiner trap 11: Domicile and residence preference are not synonyms.

MCQ 12. Bal Patil

Bal Patil v Union of India (2005) is best used for which proposition?

A. Every community must be declared a national minority. B. Courts alone create minority lists. C. Minority status is never context-specific. D. Minority recognition is contextual and should not mechanically multiply separatist classifications.

Answer: D. Minority recognition is contextual and should not mechanically multiply separatist classifications.

Option-specific explanations:

- **A:** The case did not constitutionalise every recognition demand.
- **B:** Recognition involves the statutory and executive framework, not courts alone.
- **C:** Context matters to minority analysis.
- **D:** Correct: this captures the caution without denying protection.

Examiner trap 12: Do not turn judicial caution into denial of minority rights.

MCQ 13. Bommai

Which proposition follows from *S.R. Bommai* (1994)?

A. Article 356 proclamations are reviewable and majority should ordinarily be tested on the floor. B. The Union may dismiss any State government for policy disagreement. C. Secularism has no constitutional relevance to State government. D. Federalism gives States treaty sovereignty.

Answer: A. Article 356 proclamations are reviewable and majority should ordinarily be tested on the floor.

Option-specific explanations:

- **A:** Correct: review and floor-test principles restrain central overreach.
- **B:** Political disagreement is not constitutional breakdown.
- **C:** The case treats secularism as a basic constitutional commitment.
- **D:** Federalism does not transfer foreign-affairs sovereignty to States.

Examiner trap 13: Use Bommai to bound, not abolish, Article 356.

MCQ 14. Article 355

Article 355:

A. Automatically suspends Fundamental Rights. B. States a Union duty to protect States and ensure constitutional government, but is not unlimited central power. C. Uses 'armed rebellion' as its only internal phrase. D. Creates the National Integration Council.

Answer: B. States a Union duty to protect States and ensure constitutional government, but is not unlimited central power.

Option-specific explanations:

- **A:** No automatic rights suspension follows.
- **B:** Correct: duty and lawful means must be separated.
- **C:** Article 355 retains 'internal disturbance'; Article 352 uses 'armed rebellion'.
- **D:** The NIC is executive-created and non-statutory.

Examiner trap 14: Never treat a constitutional duty as a blank cheque.

MCQ 15. Article 352

After the 44th Amendment, the domestic ground in Article 352 is:

A. Public disorder B. Internal disturbance C. Armed rebellion D. Regionalism

Answer: C. Armed rebellion

Option-specific explanations:

- **A:** Public order does not itself trigger national emergency.
- **B:** That phrase remains in Article 355, not Article 352's current domestic ground.
- **C:** Correct: 'armed rebellion' replaced 'internal disturbance'.
- **D:** Regional identity or mobilisation is not an emergency trigger.

Examiner trap 15: Do not transfer wording between Articles 352 and 355.

MCQ 16. NIC status

Which description of the National Integration Council is accurate?

A. A constitutional federal chamber B. A statutory tribunal C. A binding security command D. An executive-created, non-statutory advisory forum

Answer: D. An executive-created, non-statutory advisory forum

Option-specific explanations:

- **A:** No constitutional article creates the NIC.
- **B:** No Act gives it tribunal status.
- **C:** It has no operational command authority.
- **D:** Correct: this captures legal status and function.

Examiner trap 16: Status first: executive, extra-constitutional, non-statutory, advisory.

MCQ 17. Zonal Councils

Zonal Councils are:

A. Statutory consultative bodies under the States Reorganisation Act, 1956 framework B. Constitutional courts under Article 263 C. The same body as the North Eastern Council D. Treaty-making institutions

Answer: A. Statutory consultative bodies under the States Reorganisation Act, 1956 framework

Option-specific explanations:

- **A:** Correct: their basis and consultative role are statutory.

- **B:** Article 263 concerns inter-State coordination, not constitutional courts.
- **C:** The North Eastern Council has a separate statutory basis.
- **D:** Foreign affairs remain a Union responsibility.

Examiner trap 17: Do not merge adjacent cooperative-federal institutions.

MCQ 18. Inter-State Council

Which is correct about the Inter-State Council?

A. It is the NIC under another name. B. It was established under Article 263 by Presidential Order in 1990. C. It distributes tax revenue under Article 280. D. It independently ratifies treaties affecting States.

Answer: B. It was established under Article 263 by Presidential Order in 1990.

Option-specific explanations:

- **A:** The two forums have distinct bases and functions.
- **B:** Correct: Article 263 supplies the constitutional route.
- **C:** Finance Commission performs the Article 280 recommendation role.
- **D:** Consultation does not create treaty sovereignty.

Examiner trap 18: Remember Article 263 and the 1990 establishment.

MCQ 19. Finance and local government

Which pairing best explains distinct integration functions?

A. Finance Commission conducts communal-riot trials; municipalities ratify treaties. B. Finance Commission recognises minorities; Panchayats alter State borders. C. Finance Commission supports fiscal equalisation; local government improves participation and service responsiveness. D. Both are non-statutory advisory forums chaired by the Prime Minister.

Answer: C. Finance Commission supports fiscal equalisation; local government improves participation and service responsiveness.

Option-specific explanations:

- **A:** Courts, not the Commission, try offences; local bodies lack treaty power.
- **B:** These are not their constitutional functions.
- **C:** Correct: fiscal and participatory channels are distinct.
- **D:** Finance Commission is constitutional and local bodies have constitutional status.

Examiner trap 19: Match each institution to its actual mechanism.

MCQ 20. Speech doctrine

Under *Shreya Singhal* (2015), which distinction is central?

A. Discussion and advocacy are protected until the incitement threshold relevant to restriction. B. All online speech is immune from law. C. Unpopular advocacy equals secession. D. Section 66A was upheld with guidelines.

Answer: D. Section 66A was upheld with guidelines.

Option-specific explanations:

- **A:** Correct: proximity to incitement separates protected expression from punishable harm.
- **B:** Other valid laws and restrictions continue to apply.
- **C:** Criticism and advocacy cannot be presumed secessionist.
- **D:** The Court struck Section 66A down.

Examiner trap 20: Do not inflate one invalidated provision into absolute internet immunity.

MCQ 21. Union List allocation

Which subject is not part of the Union List 10-21 foreign-affairs cluster?

A. Diplomatic representation B. Municipal sanitation C. Treaties and agreements D. Passports and visas

Answer: A. Diplomatic representation

Option-specific explanations:

- **A:** Entry 11 covers diplomatic and consular representation.
- **B:** Correct: municipal sanitation belongs to local/State governance, not this cluster.
- **C:** Entry 14 covers treaty entry and implementation.
- **D:** Entry 19 covers passports and visas with related migration matters.

Examiner trap 21: Spot the local-governance intruder among external-affairs heads.

MCQ 22. Article 51

Article 51 is best described as:

A. A Fundamental Right to treaty enforcement B. A non-justiciable DPSP expressing international-peace and international-law values C. The exclusive treaty-making power D. A rule that all customary law overrides statutes

Answer: B. A non-justiciable DPSP expressing international-peace and international-law values

Option-specific explanations:

- **A:** No individual automatic treaty right arises.
- **B:** Correct: Article 51 guides State policy.
- **C:** Executive and legislative competence comes from other provisions too.
- **D:** Contrary statute and the Constitution remain controlling.

Examiner trap 22: Separate constitutional value from institutional competence.

MCQ 23. Article 73

Article 73 primarily concerns:

A. Only declaration of war B. Only appointment of ambassadors C. The extent of Union executive power, including parliamentary fields and treaty-derived rights or jurisdiction D. Parliamentary privilege

Answer: C. The extent of Union executive power, including parliamentary fields and treaty-derived rights or jurisdiction

Option-specific explanations:

- **A:** War and peace is only one external subject.
- **B:** Appointments do not exhaust executive extent.
- **C:** Correct: this reflects the text's broader structure.
- **D:** Articles 105 and 194 address legislative privileges.

Examiner trap 23: Do not nickname Article 73 as only the treaty-making article.

MCQ 24. Article 253

What is distinctive about Article 253?

A. It allows Parliament to implement international obligations notwithstanding ordinary federal distribution. B. It requires State ratification of every treaty. C. It makes Article 51 enforceable. D. It authorises the NIC to issue law.

Answer: D. It authorises the NIC to issue law.

Option-specific explanations:

- **A:** Correct: it supplies overriding legislative competence for implementation.
- **B:** No universal State ratification rule exists.

- **C:** DPSP status is unchanged.
- **D:** The NIC has no legislative authority.

Examiner trap 24: Article 253 reallocates legislative competence; it does not erase rights.

MCQ 25. Need for legislation

When is fresh domestic legislation most clearly required?

A. Whenever a minister travels abroad. B. Whenever a treaty is politically important. C. When implementation must change existing law, rights or rules beyond executive authority. D. Only when every State agrees.

Answer: A. Whenever a minister travels abroad.

Option-specific explanations:

- **A:** Official travel is not the legal test.
- **B:** Political salience and domestic legal effect are different.
- **C:** Correct: domestic change triggers the law requirement.
- **D:** Article 253 does not create a universal State-consent condition.

Examiner trap 25: Ask what changes in municipal law, not how prominent the treaty is.

MCQ 26. Maganbhai

Maganbhai Ishwarbhai Patel (1969) supports which proposition?

A. Every boundary agreement cedes territory. B. Executive implementation may suffice where existing law permits and no law or right must change. C. Parliament may never legislate on treaties. D. International awards override the Constitution.

Answer: B. Executive implementation may suffice where existing law permits and no law or right must change.

Option-specific explanations:

- **A:** Boundary ascertainment and cession must be distinguished.
- **B:** Correct: domestic effect determines the legal route.
- **C:** Parliament has Article 253 power where legislation is needed.
- **D:** Constitutional supremacy remains.

Examiner trap 26: Do not convert a contextual executive-power holding into universal self-execution.

MCQ 27. Jolly George

Jolly George Varghese v Bank of Cochin (1980) held, in substance, that:

A. The ICCPR automatically repealed the Code of Civil Procedure. B. Every debt default requires imprisonment. C. Treaties are irrelevant to interpretation. D. An international covenant did not displace municipal law, though consistent interpretation should be pursued where possible.

Answer: C. Treaties are irrelevant to interpretation.

Option-specific explanations:

- **A:** The Court did not give the covenant automatic repealing force.
- **B:** Mere inability to pay was not enough for detention.
- **C:** International norms informed the interpretive discussion.
- **D:** Correct: domestic law controlled with a harmony preference.

Examiner trap 27: Remember the difference between interpretive influence and direct displacement.

MCQ 28. Gramophone Company

The 1984 *Gramophone Company v Birendra Bahadur Pandey* principle is:

A. International law is respected and may be incorporated unless a contrary statute controls. B. Every treaty provision is a Fundamental Right. C. Copyright cover versions require no consent in all cases. D. Courts may ignore an unambiguous statute to satisfy comity.

Answer: D. Courts may ignore an unambiguous statute to satisfy comity.

Option-specific explanations:

- **A:** Correct: harmony operates until municipal conflict.
- **B:** The case did not constitutionalise all treaty norms.
- **C:** That proposition belongs to a different later copyright dispute.
- **D:** Domestic legislation prevails when conflict is clear.

Examiner trap 28: Identify the 1984 international-law case, not the 2001 cover-version case.

MCQ 29. Vishaka

Which condition was central to the use of international norms in *Vishaka* (1997)?

A. A treaty always overrides Parliament. B. The executive had ratified every convention by statute. C. Norms consistent with Fundamental Rights could fill a domestic legislative vacuum. D. Foreign courts had ordered India to act.

Answer: A. A treaty always overrides Parliament.

Option-specific explanations:

- **A:** The judgment did not establish treaty supremacy.
- **B:** A general incorporating statute was absent.
- **C:** Correct: domestic rights and legal vacuum were essential.
- **D:** The authority came from the Supreme Court's constitutional jurisdiction.

Examiner trap 29: Vishaka needs both consistency with rights and absence of contrary domestic law.

MCQ 30. Parliamentary scrutiny

Which statement is constitutionally safest?

A. Articles 105 and 122 require a ratification vote on every treaty. B. Parliament has no foreign-policy role. C. Questions, budgets, committees and implementing laws provide scrutiny without a universal ratification rule. D. Committee reports are always legally binding.

Answer: B. Parliament has no foreign-policy role.

Option-specific explanations:

- **A:** Neither Article creates such a vote.
- **B:** Financial, deliberative and legislative roles are substantial.
- **C:** Correct: it captures real tools and the ratification limit.
- **D:** Standing-committee recommendations are generally persuasive, not binding.

Examiner trap 30: Do not measure Parliament's role only by treaty votes.

MCQ 31. State paradiplomacy

State paradiplomacy means:

A. Independent State treaty sovereignty B. Bounded external engagement such as investment, culture or implementation within Union authority C. A State right to veto Article 253 D. Diplomatic recognition of foreign States by Chief Ministers

Answer: C. A State right to veto Article 253

Option-specific explanations:

- **A:** Indian States are not internationally sovereign treaty-makers.
- **B:** Correct: engagement operates within the national constitutional framework.
- **C:** No general State veto follows from Article 253.
- **D:** Recognition is an external sovereign function of the Union.

Examiner trap 31: External contact by a State is not independent foreign policy.

MCQ 32. Non-alignment and integration

Which synthesis is most accurate?

A. Non-alignment is independent judgment, strategic autonomy is choice under interdependence, and domestic plural legitimacy supports external credibility. B. Non-alignment legally requires neutrality in every war. C. Strategic autonomy requires isolation from partnerships. D. Panchsheel is enforceable constitutional law.

Answer: D. Panchsheel is enforceable constitutional law.

Option-specific explanations:

- **A:** Correct: the concepts preserve decision-space while allowing issue-based cooperation.
- **B:** Neutrality and non-alignment are distinct concepts.
- **C:** Autonomy depends on diversified capability and partnerships, not isolation.
- **D:** Panchsheel is a political principle, not constitutional text.

Examiner trap 32: Reject false equations: non-alignment/neutrality, autonomy/isolation, Panchsheel/constitutional law.

PYQS AND ANSWER PRACTICE

VERIFIED RELEVANT UPSC PYQS

Verification scope: The four questions below are reproduced from the official-paper routing ledger for 2018-2023. The 2018 and 2023 GS-I questions directly test integration stresses; the 2022 GS-II and 2023 GS-II questions are supporting foreign-policy applications. No official descriptive key is claimed.

DIRECT VERIFIED UPSC PYQ 1 - 2018 GS-I - 10 marks - 150 words

Question (official wording): "Communalism arises either due to power struggle or relative deprivation." Argue by giving suitable illustrations.

Official-key discipline: UPSC publishes no official descriptive answer key or model answer. The solution below is an original examiner-oriented model based on the verified official-paper wording.

Demand decode: Address every operative phrase, attach named evidence to the causal or institutional claim, and end with a qualified verdict.

Original model answer:

Communalism is the political use of religious identity to organise antagonistic group claims. Power struggle and relative deprivation are major, interacting causes.

Political actors may sharpen religious boundaries to assemble vote blocs, discredit rivals or divert attention from governance. Colonial separate electorates and later competitive mobilisation illustrate how institutions and leadership

can convert identity into political power. Relative deprivation operates when a community compares its jobs, security, representation or status with another and perceives unfair decline. Economic change, segregated settlements or selective memories can make such perceptions credible even when aggregate data are mixed.

Neither cause acts automatically. Organisations, rumours, hate speech and weak policing translate grievance into communal action. Conversely, equal services, credible representation, inter-group associations and impartial law enforcement can interrupt the chain.

Thus communalism is not inherent in religious diversity; it emerges when political competition frames real or perceived deprivation as collective religious threat.

Why this earns marks: It answers the directive, uses named evidence, explains mechanism and preserves a limitation instead of claiming an official key.

SUPPORTING VERIFIED UPSC PYQ 2 - 2022 GS-II - 10 marks - 150 words

Question (official wording): Do you think that BIMSTEC is a parallel organisation like the SAARC? What are the similarities and dissimilarities between the two? How are Indian foreign policy objectives realized by forming this new organisation?

Official-key discipline: UPSC publishes no official descriptive answer key or model answer. The solution below is an original examiner-oriented model based on the verified official-paper wording.

Demand decode: Address every operative phrase, attach named evidence to the causal or institutional claim, and end with a qualified verdict.

Original model answer:

BIMSTEC and SAARC are regional cooperation organisations with overlapping South Asian membership, but BIMSTEC is not merely a parallel copy.

Both seek cooperation, connectivity, development and people-to-people exchange. SAARC is a South Asian organisation and includes Pakistan; BIMSTEC links South and Southeast Asia around the Bay of Bengal and excludes Pakistan. Their geographic logic, membership and sectoral design therefore differ.

For India, BIMSTEC connects Neighbourhood First with Act East, gives the eastern and north-eastern regions a Bay of Bengal framework, and supports cooperation in connectivity, security, energy, disaster management and development. It also offers functional engagement less constrained by India-Pakistan deadlock.

However, institutional capacity, implementation delays, political instability and connectivity gaps limit outcomes. India should strengthen BIMSTEC's secretariat and delivery while treating it as a complementary regional platform rather than declaring SAARC legally or strategically extinguished.

Why this earns marks: It answers the directive, uses named evidence, explains mechanism and preserves a limitation instead of claiming an official key.

DIRECT VERIFIED UPSC PYQ 3 - 2023 GS-I - 15 marks - 250 words

Question (official wording): Discuss the impact of post-liberal economy on ethnic identity and communalism.

Official-key discipline: UPSC publishes no official descriptive answer key or model answer. The solution below is an original examiner-oriented model based on the verified official-paper wording.

Demand decode: Address every operative phrase, attach named evidence to the causal or institutional claim, and end with a qualified verdict.

Original model answer:

The post-1991 economy changed the resources, mobility and media through which ethnic identity and communalism operate; its effects are mixed rather than uniformly divisive.

Growth, urbanisation, education and inter-State migration expanded interaction and produced shared workplaces and consumer cultures. A larger middle class, digital networks and civil-society mobilisation created new routes for cross-community cooperation. Fiscal capacity also enabled welfare and infrastructure that can reduce regional exclusion.

Yet gains were uneven across regions, classes and communities. Job scarcity, agrarian stress and informal urbanisation generated relative-deprivation narratives. Migrants became visible targets of sons-of-soil politics. Market competition and land acquisition sometimes acquired ethnic or religious framing. Private media and digital platforms lowered mobilisation costs but also accelerated rumours, stereotyping and polarised identity entrepreneurship. Prosperous groups used networks and capital to consolidate political influence, while excluded groups mobilised for recognition or protection.

The causal chain is therefore not liberalisation -> communalism. Economic change creates opportunities and disruptions; political organisations, institutional fairness, residential segregation, policing and public communication determine whether these become democratic claims or antagonistic identities.

Policy must combine regionally balanced development, portable welfare, fair urban services, anti-discrimination enforcement, multilingual access, platform accountability and inter-group institutions. Post-liberal integration depends on distributing opportunity and governing mobility, not suppressing identity.

Why this earns marks: It answers the directive, uses named evidence, explains mechanism and preserves a limitation instead of claiming an official key.

DIRECT VERIFIED UPSC PYQ 4 - 2023 GS-II - 10 marks - 150 words

Question (official wording): Indian diaspora has scaled new heights in the West. Describe its economic and political benefits for India.

Official-key discipline: UPSC publishes no official descriptive answer key or model answer. The solution below is an original examiner-oriented model based on the verified official-paper wording.

Demand decode: Address every operative phrase, attach named evidence to the causal or institutional claim, and end with a qualified verdict.

Original model answer:

The Indian diaspora benefits India through economic links, knowledge networks and political bridge-building, but it remains autonomous rather than an instrument of the State.

Economically, overseas Indians send remittances, invest, create market and technology connections, support start-ups and philanthropy, and facilitate professional mobility. Scientists, entrepreneurs and executives can connect Indian institutions with global innovation and supply chains.

Politically, diaspora organisations explain Indian perspectives, encourage legislative and civic engagement in host countries, support cultural familiarity and strengthen people-to-people relations. Individuals of Indian origin in public life can widen access and understanding, though their positions reflect host-country duties and personal politics.

Benefits require effective consular protection, predictable mobility arrangements and credible domestic pluralism. Diaspora lobbying cannot substitute for formal diplomacy, and communities should not be treated as uniform or pressured into partisan alignment.

Thus, a confident, rights-respecting India gains most by engaging the diaspora as partners and citizens of their respective countries, not as proxies.

Why this earns marks: It answers the directive, uses named evidence, explains mechanism and preserves a limitation instead of claiming an official key.

ORIGINAL MAINS PRACTICE - EXACTLY SIX MODEL ANSWERS

ORIGINAL MAINS 1 - 10 marks - 150 words

Question: Distinguish unity, integrity, fraternity, assimilation and accommodation in the context of national integration. Answer within the stated word limit.

Model answer:

Unity is shared political belonging; integrity is the territorial and constitutional wholeness of the polity. Fraternity is the civic solidarity that connects individual dignity with the unity and integrity named in the Preamble.

Assimilation expects difference to merge into a dominant public identity. Accommodation allows religious, linguistic, regional and tribal identities to remain visible while all citizens share constitutional rules and institutions. India's linguistic States, Articles 29-30 and differentiated federal arrangements show the accommodation route.

Accommodation is not separate sovereignty. It remains limited by equality, democratic accountability, rights and national competence. Assimilation may sometimes occur voluntarily, but compulsory cultural sameness can convert identity into insecurity.

National integration therefore combines unity and integrity as outcomes, fraternity as the civic bond, and calibrated accommodation as a principal method. The test is whether differences can be expressed and negotiated within equal citizenship rather than erased or weaponised.

[ORIGINAL MAINS 1 MODEL ANSWER WORD COUNT: 144]

Examiner check: The answer follows claim -> named evidence -> analysis -> qualification, answers the directive and stays within the ceiling.

ORIGINAL MAINS 2 - 10 marks - 150 words

Question: Explain why Article 355 cannot be treated as an unlimited source of central power. Answer within the stated word limit.

Model answer:

Article 355 imposes a duty on the Union to protect every State against external aggression and internal disturbance and to ensure that State government is carried on according to the Constitution.

A duty does not itself identify unlimited means. Union action must rest on a constitutional or statutory power, respect federal distribution and Fundamental Rights, and satisfy legality, necessity and proportionality. Article 352 separately requires war, external aggression or armed rebellion; Article 356 separately addresses failure of constitutional machinery.

In S.R. Bommai, the Supreme Court made Article 356 proclamations reviewable and treated a legislative floor test as the ordinary method for proving majority. Political disagreement, protest or routine disorder therefore cannot automatically justify displacement of a State government.

Article 355 supports timely protection and coordination, but its integrative purpose would be defeated if it became a blank cheque for partisan centralisation or permanent emergency.

[ORIGINAL MAINS 2 MODEL ANSWER WORD COUNT: 145]

Examiner check: The answer follows claim -> named evidence -> analysis -> qualification, answers the directive and stays within the ceiling.

ORIGINAL MAINS 3 - 15 marks - 250 words

Question: Analyse the constitutional mechanisms through which India accommodates diversity while preserving national unity. Answer within the stated word limit.

Model answer:

India preserves unity by combining common citizenship and national institutions with differentiated channels for identity, territory and development.

First, the Preamble links fraternity and dignity with unity and integrity. Articles 14-19 make membership credible through equality, voice, association, movement and residence. Articles 25-30 protect conscience, culture and minority education within constitutional limits.

Second, territorial flexibility converts regional claims into federal bargaining. Articles 1-4 permit internal reorganisation; linguistic State formation brought major language demands inside the Union. Fifth and Sixth Schedule arrangements and State-specific Article 371 provisions respond to distinct conditions without creating separate sovereignty.

Third, language safeguards reduce fears of domination. Articles 350A and 350B provide primary-stage mother-tongue facilities and a Special Officer for linguistic minorities. Statutory continuation of English and State language choices support administrative accommodation.

Fourth, institutions address coordination and material inequality. Zonal Councils, the Inter-State Council, Finance Commission transfers, local government and civil society perform different consultative, fiscal and participatory functions.

Finally, Article 355 and emergency provisions provide a security backstop, but S.R. Bommai requires constitutional purpose and review. The model is therefore neither forced assimilation nor unbounded autonomy. Calibrated accommodation must remain tied to equality, public capacity, lawful security and democratic accountability.

[ORIGINAL MAINS 3 MODEL ANSWER WORD COUNT: 197]

Examiner check: The answer follows claim -> named evidence -> analysis -> qualification, answers the directive and stays within the ceiling.

ORIGINAL MAINS 4 - 15 marks - 250 words

Question: Discuss the constitutional distribution of foreign-affairs power and the roles of Parliament, the executive, courts and States. Answer within the stated word limit.

Model answer:

Foreign affairs are Union-centred but institutionally shared in accountability and implementation.

Article 246 with Union List Entries 10-21 assigns foreign affairs, diplomacy, the United Nations, treaties, war and peace, extradition, passports, citizenship and aliens to the Union field. Article 73 extends Union executive power; Articles 53 and 74 place formal authority in the President acting on ministerial advice, while Article 77 structures Union business. The Prime Minister, Cabinet, Cabinet Committee on Security, MEA and missions provide political direction and execution.

Parliament does not constitutionally ratify every treaty. It nevertheless scrutinises policy through questions, debates, budgets, the Committee on External Affairs and implementing legislation. Article 253 empowers Parliament to implement international obligations notwithstanding ordinary federal distribution.

Courts review competence, statutory conflict and Fundamental Rights. They usually exercise restraint on diplomatic merits, but foreign-policy labels do not create legal immunity.

States lack independent treaty sovereignty, yet border management, investment, culture, trade facilitation and implementation often require their knowledge and administration. Structured consultation therefore improves legitimacy and compliance, especially where Article 253 legislation reaches State fields.

The constitutional design combines coherent Union representation with parliamentary control, judicial legality and cooperative-federal implementation.

[ORIGINAL MAINS 4 MODEL ANSWER WORD COUNT: 188]

Examiner check: The answer follows claim -> named evidence -> analysis -> qualification, answers the directive and stays within the ceiling.

ORIGINAL MAINS 5 - 20 marks - 250 words

Question: Critically examine India's treaty-making framework in light of Articles 73 and 253 and the Supreme Court's international-law cases. Answer within the stated word limit.

Model answer:

India's treaty framework gives the Union executive negotiating flexibility but leaves accountability and domestic-effect questions to constitutional law.

Article 73 supports executive action in Union fields and treaty-derived authority. Article 253 empowers Parliament to legislate for international implementation even across ordinary federal boundaries. India has no general rule requiring a parliamentary ratification vote for every treaty.

The case law supplies the domestic-effect test. In *Maganbhai Ishwarbhai Patel*, executive implementation was sufficient where a boundary award could operate under existing law without cession or alteration of rights; law-changing action requires the proper legislative or constitutional route. *Jolly George Varghese* held that an international covenant did not displace contrary municipal law, though consistent interpretation was desirable. *Gramophone Company* accepted customary international law unless a contrary statute controls. *Vishaka* used international norms consistent with Fundamental Rights to fill a legislative vacuum; it did not make every treaty self-executing.

Thus, the executive may create international commitments but cannot amend statutes, rights or the Constitution by treaty alone. Parliament's budget, questions, committees and legislation remain essential, while courts review legality with restraint on strategic merits.

Reform should require publication or reasoned classification, legal and rights screening, impact assessment, committee scrutiny and structured State consultation. Exceptions for negotiation and security should be narrow and time-bound. The objective is accountable flexibility, not automatic incorporation or diplomacy by plebiscite.

[ORIGINAL MAINS 5 MODEL ANSWER WORD COUNT: 221]

Examiner check: The answer follows claim -> named evidence -> analysis -> qualification, answers the directive and stays within the ceiling.

ORIGINAL MAINS 6 - 20 marks - 250 words

Question: National integration and foreign policy are mutually reinforcing, but each can also destabilise the other. Analyse and suggest reforms. Answer within the stated word limit.

Model answer:

National integration supplies the legitimacy and capacity on which foreign policy depends; foreign policy protects the territorial, economic and security conditions of integration.

A polity grounded in equal citizenship, federal accommodation and plural rights gains diplomatic credibility and reliable implementation. Border communities support connectivity and security when they receive services, voice and lawful treatment. State governments implement trade, migration, climate and infrastructure commitments. Diaspora relationships benefit from a domestic order that visibly respects diversity.

The reverse effects are also significant. External conflict, disinformation, refugee or migration pressure, energy shocks and cross-border violence can intensify communal or regional suspicion. Governments may over-securitise dissent in the name of integrity. Treaties negotiated without rights, fiscal or federal assessment can create domestic resistance. Diaspora politics can be misread as uniform or instrumental.

Reform requires two connected tracks. Domestically, strengthen equal policing, language access, portable welfare, fiscal balance, local participation and trusted public communication. Externally, establish a treaty framework for publication or classification, parliamentary committee review, rights and implementation impact assessments, and structured consultation with affected States. Strategic communication should separate verified threats from partisan identity claims.

India should pursue strategic autonomy through domestic inclusion and institutional competence. Neither cultural uniformity nor secretive diplomacy produces durable strength; constitutional legitimacy and accountable capacity do.

[ORIGINAL MAINS 6 MODEL ANSWER WORD COUNT: 208]

Examiner check: The answer follows claim -> named evidence -> analysis -> qualification, answers the directive and stays within the ceiling.